

River of fire

The red-hot molten rock that is streaming down the sides of this volcano is beautiful but deadly. It is so hot that it can melt steel.



Clouds of ash and gas pour out from the crater.

Molten rock, called magma, rises up the main pipe and any branch pipes.

A volcano builds up from layers of ash and lava.

Branch pipe

Magma collects in a chamber found deep underground. It is forced up through cracks and holes in the ground.

Mixed bunch

When lava cools and hardens, it can make rocks with different shapes. Here are three types:



Aa lava



Pahoehoe lava



A volcanic 'bomb'